



Fortnite and Prom?

Teens have found a new way to craft their 'promposals': using Fortnite to ask out their dates. <https://digit.in/fortniteprom>



PUBG Mobile Arcade Mode

PUBG Mobile launched a less-intense arcade mode which lowers the number of players from 100 to 24. <https://digit.in/pubgmob>

THE HISTORY OF STORMTROOPERS

Tracing the evolution of Stormtroopers over the current Star Wars canon.

Aditya Madanapalle | aditya@digit.in

S

tormtroopers have evolved considerably over the course of the current Star Wars canon, but the release

patterns of the parts of the story, has made the evolution is not strictly linear. While within the story, the armour has gotten better, the constraints of the time during which the movies were produced is visibly telling. For example, the knee guards of the stormtroopers went from being flexible in the prequel trilogy, to being rigid or non-existent in the original trilogy, and back to being flexible in the sequel trilogy.

HISTORY

Essentially, there are three variants of the stormtroopers in the three trilogies. In Episodes I, II and III, the stormtroopers are Clone troopers. These are all soldiers cloned from a single individual, Jango Fett. Initially, the Clones were produced only on Kamino. The Kaminoans specialised in cloning technologies, but later on the clones were grown on other worlds as well. The Clone troopers obeyed the Jedi commanders, but they actually served the Republic Chancellor, Palpatine who would eventually make the



Clone troopers kill their Jedi Generals, and execute Jedi everywhere.

After the execution of Order 66, the stormtroopers served the Galactic Republic, and became known as the Imperial stormtroopers. During this period, the original Clone troopers started dying off because they aged at twice the rate of normal humans. The clones were gradually replaced with regular citizens from the galaxy, who were indoctrinated into unquestionable loyalty to Emperor Palpatine from a very young age.

After the defeat of Emperor Palpatine, The First Order rose from the Ashes of the Empire. The stormtroopers then began to serve The First Order, their numbers were maintained by abducting children. The armour of the First Order stormtroopers were upgraded, and they were given newer weapons for more specialised roles. Apart from the equipment, the training methods were also changed by the First Order. The First Order training regime focused on improvisation and guerilla tactics. Through most of the history

of stormtroopers, their only official personal identifications are serial numbers. Under the Jedi, Clone Commanders were given personalised names.

Clone troopers, Imperial stormtroopers and First Order stormtroopers neatly coincide with the three Star Wars trilogies.

ARMOUR

The basic armour of the stormtroopers have remained essentially the same from their inception. Jango Fett provided consultation for the design of the armour, but the blunt design also shows Kaminoan influence. The Kaminoans could see only in the ultraviolet range, which is why the original Clone trooper armour was stark white. The armour lasts practically indefinitely.

The white armoured shell covered a pressurised black body glove. The body glove, along with a life support system in the backplate offers protection for brief durations even in the vacuum of space. The body glove also provides thermal regulation to the troopers. A space backpack with a longer life